Where the name came from

The word "nomadology" has more roots than the nomads. In Greek, the pasture came before both the law and any people, and Deleuze took his nomos from that philology in 1968, long before the steppe. In *A Thousand Plateaus* the word first names a lack, and later what monadology turns into once its units open. Each row gives a source and what the word named there, along with what it brings to the name.

When	Where	What the word names	What it brings to the name
Homer	Laroche 1949 115-17	*Nomós*, the pasture: "un espace illimité" ("an unlimited space"), a forest, river meadows, a mountainside, and for humans "a habitat without recognized limits"	A distribution of herds across a space no one divides. Only from the fifth century B.C. was the word brought close to *némō*, "to share" 115
Hesiod to Attic Greek	Laroche 166, 196	*Nómos*, in which the musical, religious, moral and political senses "appear at once"	Music is as old as law in the word. Law, and "scientific law" (nomology), is the later, narrowed sense 196
Plato, *Statesman* 266e	Laroche 118-19	*Nomeús*, the distributor, becomes a title of the king, the "shepherd of peoples," and law is what grazes the human herd	Philosophers turned a word for pasture into a word for rule. A pasture tax belongs to the same family 118
Pindar, Herodotus	Laroche 121	*Nomádes*, said of the Libyans, is "an adjective" that names "a way of life, not a nation"	The name of a people is the later form. The older one names a way of grazing, dwelling and spreading out
Schmitt, 1950 and 1953	*The Nomos of the Earth* 70, 324-26	Nomos as "the initial measure and division of pastureland," with "to take" (*nehmen*) as the first meaning of *nemein*	Schmitt cites Laroche and sets the philology aside 324 n. 1, so taking comes first by a jurist's choice, not by etymology
Deleuze, 1968	*Difference and Repetition* 36-37 and n. 6	A "nomadic distribution," a nomos "without property, enclosure or measure," taken from Laroche	The word enters Deleuze's philosophy as a way of distributing being, twelve years before any steppe peoples appear in it
Deleuze, 1972	"Nomad Thought" 146-49	Nomadism as "a perpetual displacement in the intensities," and a nomad who "is not necessarily one who moves"	A thought set against philosophy, which "is born out of the imperial state" and stays tied to law 148
A Thousand Plateaus, 1980	Plateau 1 23	"What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history," because history is written "from the sedentary point of view"	The word first names something missing
	Plateau 3 43	One of seven names Professor Challenger gives his discipline, beside rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, micropolitics, pragmatics and the science of multiplicities	The name is one alias among others, and a joke: "no one clearly understood" the discipline's goals or method
	Plateau 12 351-423	"Treatise on Nomadology," where the war machine is given to the nomads "only in the historical interest of demonstrating" that it was invented 422	The plateau withdraws the people its title seems to name
	Plateau 14 494, 574 n. 27	After Châtelet on Riemann, monads "no longer thought to be closed upon themselves," linked "step-by-step," so that monadology "should be superseded by a 'nomadology'"	A second root, with no people in it: units opened and linked locally. *Nomad* is also an anagram of *monad*
1986	Semiotext(e)	*Nomadology: The War Machine*, plateau 12 printed alone in English	The booklet cut the treatise off from plateau 13 and from the monad note. It became the English reception's text
Deleuze, 1988	*The Fold* 137	Monads "kept half open as if by a pair of pliers," held in "transitory captures," in habitats that "overtake monadology with a 'nomadology'"	The opened monad again, now with capture in the same passage
1993 to 2004	Miller, Braidotti, Bogue	Miller traces the nomads to the colonial anthropology in the notes. Braidotti makes the nomad a figure of the subject. Bogue defends a "bastard concept"	The quarrel over the word is mostly a quarrel over the peoples it seems to name

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What nomadology is not, and other names

Several approaches outside Deleuze and Guattari's orbit look like nomadology from a distance, and each shares something with it. They are useful as contrasts, since what separates them from nomadology is usually where they start, from a people to be given back its history or from a history to be told otherwise.

Approach	Works	What it shares with nomadology	Where nomadology differs
Genealogy	Foucault, "Nietzsche, Genealogy, History" (1971)	Against origins and against history told from above. "Effective history" places us "among countless lost events, without a landmark or a point of reference" (155)	*Genealogy remains a kind of history. Nomadology is "the opposite of a history"* 23 *and studies processes that coexist in every formation* 437
History of the people left out	Wolf, *Europe and the People without History* (1982)	Refuses the "primitive contemporaries" (25) who were said to have no history. Wolf's world is no "global pool hall" of bounded societies (6)	*Wolf puts "the people to whom history has been denied" into "the same historical trajectory" (23). Nomadology doesn't seek a place in history for them. It questions the sedentary point of view from which history is written*
Silences of the archive	Trouillot, *Silencing the Past* (1995)	Power enters the record at every stage, from making sources and archives to making narratives	*Trouillot asks what a record silences. Nomadology also asks what the State converted and then presented as its own invention*
Legibility and state evasion	Scott, *Seeing Like a State* (1998), *The Art of Not Being Governed* (2009), *Against the Grain* (2017)	Counting as a way of making a population legible, and peoples who live beyond the State's reach, from Zomia to "The Golden Age of the Barbarians"	*Scott's units are States and the peoples who escape them. Nomadology names no people. Its processes run inside States as well as outside them*
A history of freedoms	Graeber and Wengrow, *The Dawn of Everything* (2021)	Against stages, they find seasonal changes of social form and societies that chose against hierarchy	*Theirs is still an account of what past peoples chose. Nomadology asks how a formation wards off a threshold it has never crossed* 437-39
Studies of pastoral nomads	Khazanov, *Nomads and the Outside World* (1983), Lindner, "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982)	The steppe itself. Lindner finds the tribe was "a political organism open to all who were willing to subordinate themselves to its chief" (701)	*These fields study nomads as peoples and economies. The plateaus define the nomad by a way of inhabiting space, not by a people or an economy* 380-81
Mobility studies	Sheller and Urry, "The New Mobilities Paradigm" (2006)	Takes movement seriously, against theories of society built on settlement	*The nomad is "he who does not move"* 381*. What nomadology studies is a distribution in space, not travel*
Nomos as appropriation	Schmitt, *The Nomos of the Earth* (1950)	The same Greek word, and the same concern with how the earth is ordered	*Schmitt's nomos begins with taking and dividing land. Nomadology begins from the pasture that no one divides* 557 n. 51

Names already in use

Challenger's six others. Rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities 43

Minor science, nomad science. The science that follows its material, against royal science 361-74. It is the name of this site

Nomad thought. The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, and of the thought set against the State form 376-80

Mobile pastoralism. What steppe research now calls the way of life once named nomadism (Humphrey and Sneath). It names an economy, not a method

What a new name would need

1. Name no people, because a people was never the root
2. Keep distribution without division, the pasture no one parcels out
3. Keep the opened unit and the local link, step by step
4. Put politics before being, as *Mille plateaux* does ("avant l'être, il y a la politique," "before being, there is politics," *Mille plateaux* 249)
5. Avoid ending in a law or a *logos*, or make that ending visible on purpose
6. Be sayable outside the university

Where one could come from

From the opened monad. Named for the local, step-by-step link that replaces the closed unit 494, 574 n. 27

From *nem-*. Named for distributing rather than dividing, with the people left out

From the method. Following, the problematic, rigor without exactness. This is closest to minor science

From Challenger's list. Take one of the aliases, or add an eighth, as the joke allows 43

Keep the name and turn it. Tell the word's own history, in which a habitat without limits was later claimed as a division

Our own observation, which Deleuze and Guattari do not make, is that "nomado-logy" puts a logos over the nomos. Plateau 12 calls this move "the triumph of the logos or the law over the nomos" 373.

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